

This week in polling: Trump's approval rating slides to new low

送信者: EG US Daily 受信日時: 2026-08-01 01:29

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Editorial note: EG's US daily will shift to a Tuesday and Thursday publication schedule for the month of August, beginning Monday 3 August. This week |||||

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This week in polling: Trump's approval rating slides to new low. After dropping below 40% last week, President Trump's approval rating fell slightly more this week, from 38.8% to 38.2% in Silver Bulletin's approval-rating tracker. In Quinnipiac's national poll, President Trump's approval rating registered at 32%. This continued decline likely reflects the impact of further US strikes in Iran after the resumption of hostilities with no clear off ramp (please see US Daily: Trump's last-minute pause on escalation does not create an off-ramp with Iran 27 July, 2026).

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The congressional generic ballot has stayed consistent this week, with Democrats claiming a 6.4-point lead, with some polls placing the lead as high as 11 points. Democrats remain the strong favorites in the House race (85% odds to flip the chamber), though we assess the odds of a 2018-style "wave" election remain low (see US Daily: Separating signal from noise in Trump's latest tariff rollout 24 July, 2026).

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This week's Senate race polling indicates mounting momentum across the board for Democrats. In Georgia, Senator Jon Ossoff (D-GA) expanded his lead on his Republican opponent to 13 points. Democrats also have eked out leads in North Carolina, Ohio, and Iowa, according to Fox News polls: Roy Cooper (+9), Sherod Brown (+8), and Josh Turek (+4).

Announcement of Hamas deal keeps Gaza on the back burner for Trump. Nine months after a US-brokered ceasefire ended hostilities in Gaza, President Trump announced a deal with Hamas that will see the group disarm in a multi-stage process.

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The details of the deal remain unclear, but for Trump the key point is that Gaza now appears to be a back-burner issue for the White House. This shifts the focus of US-Israeli relations to the conflict in Iran, where Trump wants to avoid anything that could upset negotiations. Hamas indicated it would follow through on the framework laid out by the Board of Peace, though Israel has yet to comment on President Trump's announcement.

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Israel has long held that the framework is contingent on Hamas's disarmament, and is unlikely to pull back significant forces or make major concessions absent that disarmament or ahead of its October elections, where Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu faces a tough reelection battle.

US approach to Japan, Korea imperils shipbuilding and nuclear energy projects. Eurasia Group's newly released Japan Angle explores Japan and South Korea's negotiating stances regarding their investment arrangements in the US, including how Washington's demands are increasing risk for projects tied to national security.

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Japan and Korea have different negotiating cultures, hinging on their views on a given project's commercial viability. Negotiators from Tokyo prefer a pragmatic approach that aims to make terms palatable to both sides, while negotiators from Seoul tend to deem nonviable projects a non-starter; this discrepancy largely explains why Japan has successfully announced more than \$100 billion in US investments to date while Korea's first investment announcement will not come before the end of August.

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Both Japan and Korea are operating under intense political time pressure from Washington. The Trump White House has pushed for tangible announcements from both Tokyo and Seoul before the US midterm elections in November, and the optics of deal delivery matter enormously to an administration that has presented these frameworks as proof of its negotiating leverage.

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Shipbuilding and nuclear energy are the two sectors with the most at stake. Shipbuilding offers the most potential upside, including trilateral cooperation. However, differing views in Congress regarding the targeted shipyards have complicated negotiations. On nuclear energy, Japan is further ahead than Korea, but safety regulations have become a sticking point for both sides.

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For more, please see Japan Angle: Tokyo pulling ahead of Seoul on US investments 30 July, 2026.

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